

Hiring Evidence Checklist

Run every hiring decision through this checklist before making an offer — or a rejection.

The evidence standard

Evidence is observed (not claimed), comparable (same standard for every candidate), and verifiable (a second reviewer would reach a similar conclusion).

Before interviewing

- ☐ Competencies for the role are defined and observable (see Competency Matrix)
- ☐ Every candidate will face the same questions, in the same order
- ☐ Scoring anchors are written — before any candidate is interviewed
- ☐ Interviewers know to score independently, before any debrief

For each candidate

- ☐ Every competency score has a written evidence note (what was said/done)
- ☐ Claims that matter were probed — 'what did you do in the first hour?'
- ☐ Skills central to the role were demonstrated, not just discussed
- ☐ No score is based on rapport, confidence, or similarity to the interviewer
- ☐ Nothing on the record references a protected characteristic

At the decision

- ☐ Scores were recorded independently before the debrief
- ☐ Disagreements were resolved by re-examining specific answers, not by averaging
- ☐ The decision can be stated as: 'scored X against rubric Y, here are the responses'
- ☐ A rejected candidate could be told the real reason without embarrassment

The one-question audit

For any decision, ask: what did we OBSERVE, and can we DEFEND it? If the honest answer is 'the team felt good about them' — you have a guess, not a decision.

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